

MARKET PULSE · MID-WEEK TRADING REPORT

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Wednesday 16 September 2026

OUTLOOK · NEUTRAL-BEARISH

MACRO THEME

The most critical 48 hours of Q3: Fed expected to deliver first rate hike in over three years (+25bp to 3.75-4.00%) at 94.5% probability. US 10Y Treasury yield breached 5% for the first time since 2007. Middle East escalation (Saudi infrastructure attacks) pushed Brent to \$108.75. Warsh press conference at 18:30 GMT is the binary event that will determine the trajectory of all seven instruments.

OVERVIEW

Risk-off dominates the front half of the week with all three major US indices declining on surging oil, 5% Treasury yields, and AI demand doubts. Energy is the sole S&P 500 sector in the green. Gold continues its bear trend (-21.8% from ATH) with geopolitical premium fully unwound — even Saudi infrastructure attacks failed to bid the metal. The Fed decision tonight is the paramount event; the question is one-and-done versus start of a tightening campaign. BoE (Thu) and BoJ (Thu) add to the central bank gauntlet. UK gilt stress (30Y near 6%) adds a financial stability dimension to the macro picture.

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LIVE MARKET DATA

INSTRUMENT	PRICE	DAY CHG %	DAY RANGE	52W RANGE	SIGNAL
US30	52,093	-0.63%	51,876 – 52,337	45,057 – 54,744	NEU-BEAR
NAS100	28,938	-0.65%	28,899 – 29,143	22,841 – 30,762	NEU-BEAR
GER40	25,402	-0.15%	25,173 – 25,479	21,864 – 26,619	BEARISH
AUDUSD	0.7134	+0.02%	0.7123 – 0.7137	0.6422 – 0.7277	NEU-BEAR
GBPCAD	1.8781	+0.13%	1.8732 – 1.8784	1.8018 – 1.9041	NEUTRAL
XAGUSD	65.21	-0.08%	63.94 – 65.39	41.49 – 121.30	NEU-BEAR
XAUUSD	4,368	-0.25%	4,315 – 4,382	3,661 – 5,586	BEARISH

SCORECARD VS PREVIOUS REPORT

INSTRUMENT	PREVIOUS BIAS	RESULT	VERDICT
US30	NEUTRAL-BEARISH	-0.91% Mon-Tue, lost 52,500 decisively	CORRECT
NAS100	NEUTRAL	-1.47% — neutral missed directional decline	PARTIALLY
GER40	NEUTRAL-BEARISH	-0.65%, broken support 26,000 held as resistance	CORRECT
AUDUSD	NEUTRAL	-0.54% — 38 pip slide on USD strength	PARTIALLY
GBPCAD	NEUTRAL-BEARISH	+0.16% — rose against bearish bias	WRONG
XAGUSD	NEUTRAL	+0.03% — effectively flat	CORRECT
XAUUSD	NEUTRAL-BEARISH	-0.92%, bear trend intact	CORRECT

TOP CONVICTION TRADES

#1 **XAUUSD** **SHORT**

ENTRY	TARGET	STOP
4,400-4,420	4,200	4,510

10Y at 5% + Fed hiking + Middle East escalation failing to bid gold = bearish regime intact. 4,292 low is fragile — hawkish Warsh breaks it. Adjusted entry from Sunday's 4,450-4,480 reflects shifted resistance. Risk-reward 1:4. Highest conviction in the basket.

#2 **GER40** **SHORT**

ENTRY	TARGET	STOP
25,550-25,700	25,000 then 24,500	25,950

Brent >\$100 + 5% US yields + ECB tightening expectations = triple headwind for German industry. Index -4.6% from ATH with no technical support until 25,000. Hawkish Fed amplifies move. Risk-reward 1:2.5 to first target.

#3 **US30** **SHORT**

ENTRY	TARGET	STOP
52,500-52,800 (post-Fed rally)	51,500	53,250

5% yields compress equity multiples; Dow industrial composition = maximum oil/rate sensitivity. 52,000 round number pierced intraday Tue. Only enter on post-Fed pop — do not chase breakdown. Dovish Warsh invalidates this trade.

INSTRUMENT ANALYSIS · 1 OF 7

US30

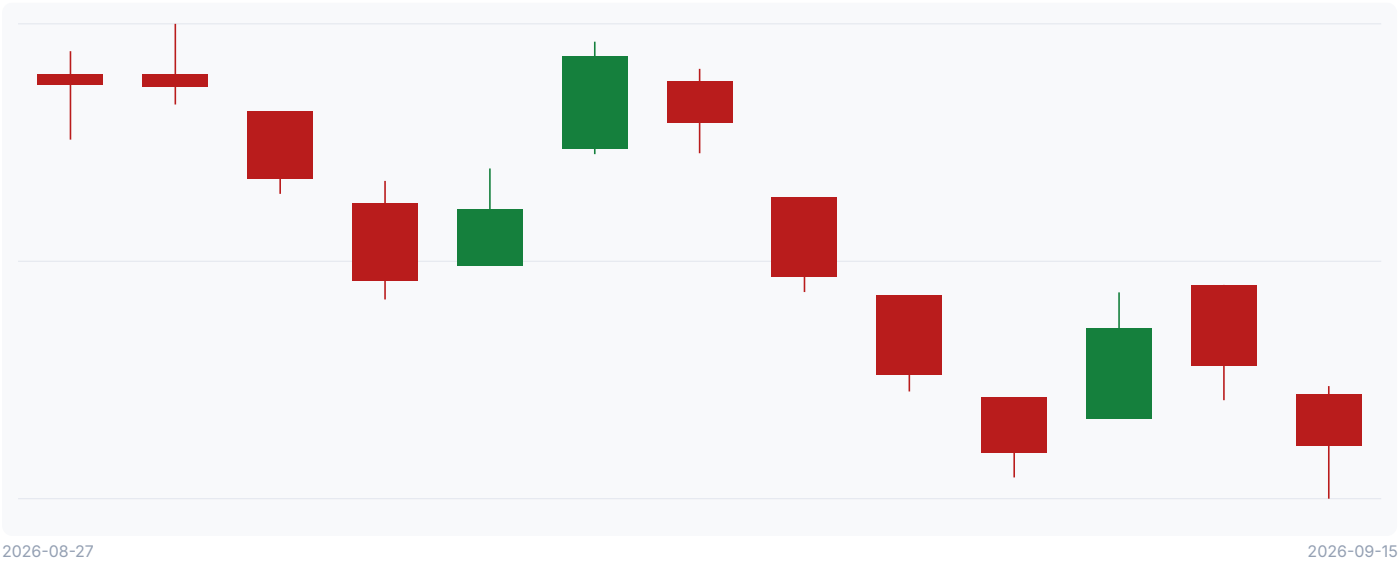
Dow Jones Industrial Average

52,093

-328 · -0.63%

NEU·BEAR · -45

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
51,876 – 52,337	45,057 – 54,744	52,421	98%

SUPPORTS		RESISTANCES	
S1	Tuesday's intraday low — short-term pivot	51,875	
S2	Prior consolidation zone from July	51,500	
S3	200DMA approximate	50,500	
R1	Monday's close — first recovery hurdle	52,421	
	Monday's high — near the missed short entry	52,751	
R2	Broken support, now firm resistance — prior bull/bear line	53,143	

ANALYSIS

Price action: US30 sold off -0.9% Mon-Tue. Tuesday's intraday low of 51,875.65 pierced the 52,000 round number before a late bid lifted the close. The 53,143 broken-support-turned-resistance is distant. Volume elevated at 15.85bn shares across US exchanges. Fundamentals: 10Y at 5.00% compresses equity multiples. Fed hike at 94.5% probability. Warsh tone is the binary. Outlook: NEUTRAL-BEARISH post-Fed. Sell any spike to 52,500-52,800 stop 53,200 target 51,500. Await press conference before committing.

INSTRUMENT ANALYSIS · 2 OF 7

NAS100

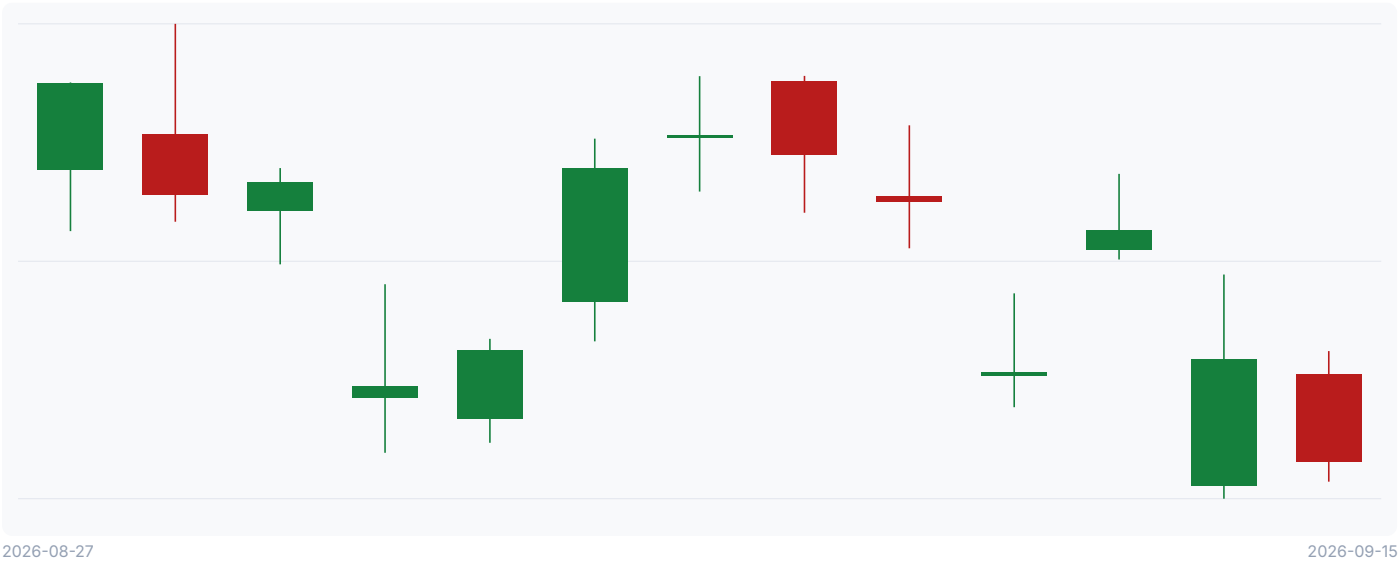
Nasdaq 100

28,938

-189 · -0.65%

NEU-BEAR · -25

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
28,899 – 29,143	22,841 – 30,762	29,127	98%

SUPPORTS

S1	Tuesday's low — must hold	28,899
	Carry-forward trade target and structural	
S2	support	28,500
S3	July swing low	27,800

RESISTANCES

R1	Monday's close	29,127
R2	Sunday's level — retest of the breakdown	29,368
R3	Prior range high, Aug-Sep	29,655

ANALYSIS

Price action: NAS100 fell hardest of three indices at -1.47% Mon-Tue. Big Tech (Alphabet, Amazon, Microsoft) all fell >1%. NVDA stabilised Tuesday. 264 new lows vs 52 new highs — breadth deterioration severe. Fundamentals: 5% 10Y is kryptonite for long-duration tech. AI demand doubts compounding rate-driven compression. Outlook: NEUTRAL-BEARISH conditional on Warsh. Hawkish opens 28,000; dovish targets 30,000. Carry-forward short in profit — consider partial at 28,500.

GER40

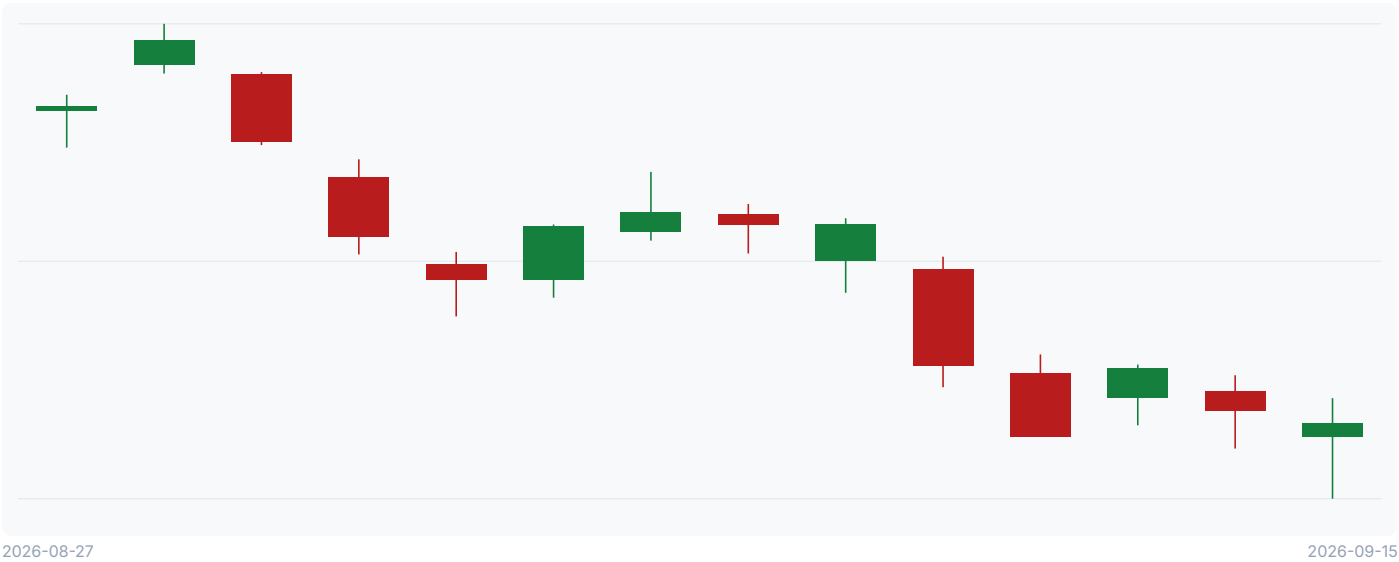
DAX Performance Index

25,402

-39 • -0.15%

BEARISH • -55

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
25,173 – 25,479	21,864 – 26,619	25,441	90%

SUPPORTS		RESISTANCES	
S1	Tuesday's low — immediate floor Sunday's conviction trade target —	R1	Sunday's close — first hurdle Conviction trade entry zone top — must hold
S2	psychological	R2	as resistance
S3	April consolidation base	R3	Broken support, now firm resistance
	25,172		25,569
	25,000		25,900
	24,500		26,000

ANALYSIS

Price action: GER40 continued structural decline, -4.6% from 26,619 ATH. Broken support 26,000 now firm resistance. Tuesday low 25,172 probed levels not seen since early August. Fundamentals: Brent >\$100 is direct cost shock for German manufacturing. Diesel at record highs. ECB expectations increasingly hawkish into October meeting. UK gilt stress spills into EU bonds. Outlook: BEARISH. Sell rallies 25,550-25,700 stop 25,950 target 25,000 then 24,500.

AUDUSD

Australian Dollar vs US Dollar

0.7134

+0.0002 • +0.02%

NEU-BEAR • -30

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE

0.7123 - 0.7137

52-WEEK RANGE

0.6422 - 0.7277

PREVIOUS CLOSE

0.7133

EVENT IMPACT

95%

SUPPORTS

- S1** Monday's low — range floor 0.7109
- S2** August swing low 0.7080
- S3** Psychological round number 0.7000

RESISTANCES

- R1** Sunday's level — first recovery 0.7173
- R2** Prior range top, Sept 7-9 0.7220
- R3** September high 0.7239

ANALYSIS

Price action: AUDUSD slid 38 pips Mon-Tue from 0.717257 to low of 0.711740 before recovering to 0.713419. Range 0.7109-0.7239 intact. Fundamentals: USD strength into Fed is dominant driver. RBA on hold — rate-divergence tailwind faded. Oil surge mixed for AUD. Outlook: NEUTRAL-BEARISH. Sell 0.7160-0.7180 stop 0.7220 target 0.7080 on hawkish Warsh. Stand aside on dovish.

GBPCAD

British Pound vs Canadian Dollar

1.8781

+0.0024 · +0.13%

NEUTRAL · -5

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
1.8732 – 1.8784	1.8018 – 1.9041	1.8757	95%

SUPPORTS			RESISTANCES		
S1	Tuesday's open — short-term floor	1.8732	R1	Tuesday's high — immediate ceiling	1.8784
S2	Monday's low	1.8714	R2	Prior week breakdown level	1.8830
S3	Prior range support	1.8650	R3	52-week high zone	1.8915

ANALYSIS

Price action: GBPCAD was the sole instrument to move against its Sunday bias, rising 30 pips. Two-day range tight at 1.8714-1.8784. CAD failed to benefit from oil surge — positioning skewed long-CAD into Fed. Fundamentals: UK 30Y gilt near 6% = existential stress. BoE Thu is paramount. Brent >\$100 structurally CAD-positive but muted by pre-Fed positioning. Outlook: NEUTRAL. Too many cross-currents. Fade extremes: buy 1.8700-1.8720 stop 1.8650 target 1.8830; sell 1.8830-1.8860 stop 1.8910 target 1.8720.

XAGUSD

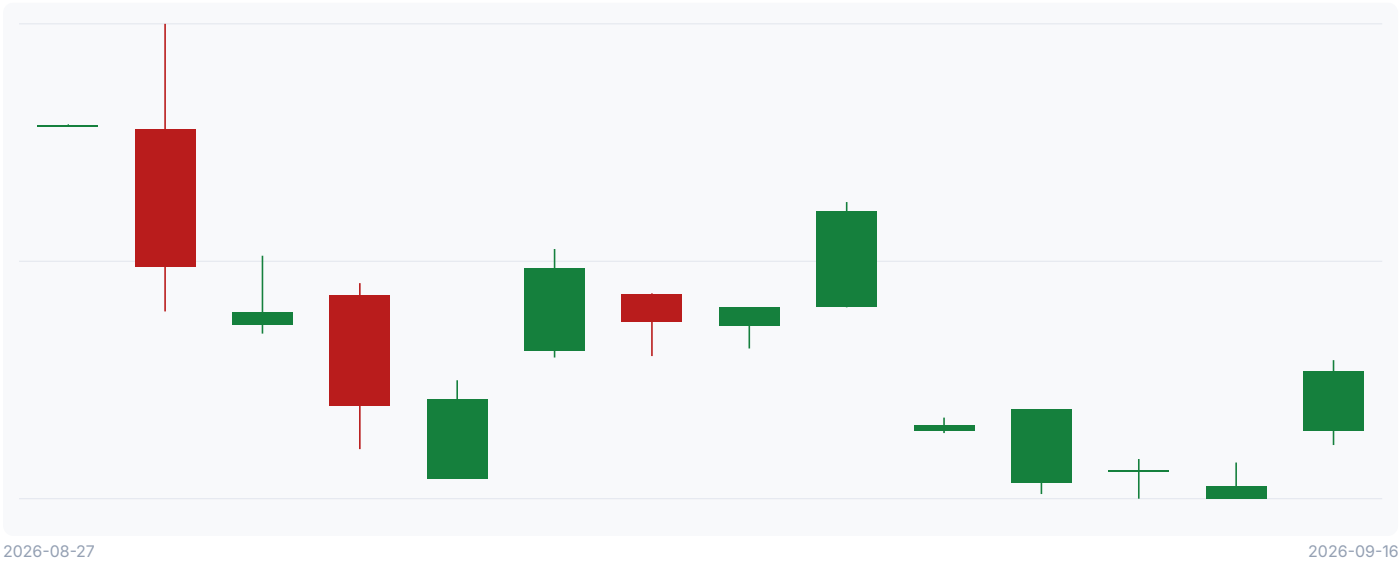
Silver Spot

65.21

-0.06 • -0.08%

NEU-BEAR • -20

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
63.94 – 65.39	41.49 – 121.30	65.26	90%

SUPPORTS			RESISTANCES		
S1	Round number, recent congestion	64.00	R1	Tuesday's high	65.40
S2	Monday's low	63.02	R2	Prior range ceiling, Sept 9	67.00
S3	Psychological / prior swing	60.00	R3	September high	68.11

ANALYSIS

Price action: Silver was the quietest instrument, closing essentially flat vs Sunday (+0.03%). Two-day range narrow: 63.02-65.40. Fundamentals: Caught between gold's bear trend and industrial demand floor (solar, semis, defence). 5% real yields toxic for non-yielding metals. Gold/silver ratio at ~67x. Outlook: NEUTRAL-BEARISH. Fed-driven. Hawkish Warsh = test 63.00 then 60.00. Dovish = relief toward 67.00. Trade with gold direction.

XAUUSD

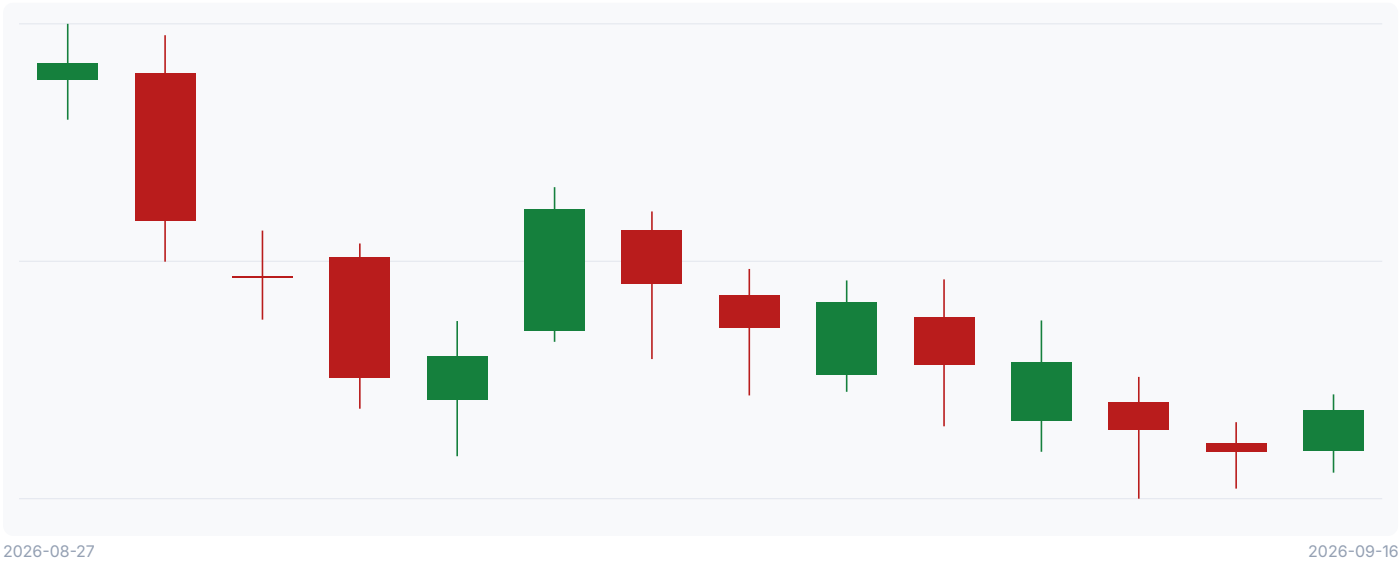
Gold Spot

4,368

-11 • -0.25%

BEARISH • -70

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE

4,315 - 4,382

52-WEEK RANGE

3,661 - 5,586

PREVIOUS CLOSE

4,379

EVENT IMPACT

98%

SUPPORTS

- S1** Correction low — must hold; break targets 4,200 4,292
- S2** Round number / pre-escalation level 4,200 4,200
- S3** Psychological — 2024 breakout zone 4,000 4,000

RESISTANCES

- R1** Round number / recent ceiling 4,400 4,400
- R2** Broken support, now firm resistance 4,510 4,510
- R3** Prior breakdown zone — distant 4,635 4,635

ANALYSIS

Price action: Gold fell \$40.70 (-0.92%) Mon-Tue. Monday low 4,293 tested the prior week's 4,292 low by a single dollar. Six consecutive lower weekly closes. -21.8% from 5,586 ATH. Fundamentals: 10Y at 5% = maximum gold headwind. Middle East escalation FAILED to bid gold — geopolitical premium fully unwound. Fed hike at 94.5% probability. Warsh tone is the binary: hawkish = 4,200; dovish = short squeeze toward 4,500. Outlook: BEARISH. Sell rallies 4,400-4,420 stop 4,510 target 4,200. Do not buy weakness. Adjusted entry from Sunday's 4,450-4,480.

UPCOMING EVENTS

DATE	TIME	EVENT	IMPACT
2026-09-16	12:30 GMT	US Retail Sales (Aug)	High
2026-09-16	18:00 GMT	FOMC Rate Decision (+25bp to 3.75-4.00% expected)	Paramount
2026-09-16	18:30 GMT	Fed Chair Warsh Press Conference	Paramount
2026-09-17	03:00 GMT	BoJ Rate Decision (+25bp to 1.25% expected)	High
2026-09-17	11:00 GMT	BoE Rate Decision	Very High
2026-09-17	12:30 GMT	US Weekly Jobless Claims	Medium
2026-09-18	14:00 GMT	US Existing Home Sales (Aug)	Medium

RISK SCENARIOS

Dovish Warsh — One-and-Done

15-20%

Violent reversal: US30 +2-3%, NAS100 +3-5%, gold +3-5%, USD -1-2%. All short conviction trades invalidated. Single most important binary for entire dashboard.

Hawkish Warsh — Start of Campaign (Base Case)

60-65%

Equities -2-4%, gold -2-3%, USD +1-2%, 10Y toward 5.25%. All three conviction trades benefit. Dot plot terminal rate above 4.25% is hawkish.

Middle East Further Escalation

20-25%

Strait of Hormuz disruption: oil +10-15%, equities -3-5%, gold bid re-emerges. True stagflation scenario complicating Fed narrative.

UK Gilt Crisis Accelerates

15-20%

30Y gilts >6.5%. BoE forced into emergency response. GBPCAD could swing 200-300 pips either direction. GBP crosses in turmoil.

Fed Holds Rates Unchanged

5%

Credibility damage. Equities initial relief then sell off. Gold could spike on signal Fed not serious about inflation. Extreme market impact despite low probability.